FOUNDER'S CODE

Participant Instructions & Guidelines

Dates: 14–15 October 2026
Venue: Sri Muthukumaran Institute of Technology (SMIT), Chennai
Duration: 24-Hour Hackathon

Welcome to **Founder's Code!** Get ready for 24 hours of innovation, problem-solving, collaboration, and building solutions that matter. Please read the following instructions carefully to ensure a smooth experience.

1. Reporting & Registration

- Registration starts from **8:30 AM on 14 October 2026**.
- Complete your registration and attendance verification upon arrival.
- Carry a valid college ID card for verification.
- Ensure all team members are present and ready for the inauguration and opening session.

2. What You Must Carry

- **Laptop - mandatory** for accessing the PET (Placement Employability Test), AI Mock Interview, and Career Passport activities.
- Laptop charger and any essential accessories.
- College ID card and registration confirmation.
- Personal essentials required for the 24-hour event.

3. Hackathon Guidelines

- The hackathon begins at **11:30 AM on 14 October** and concludes at **11:30 AM on 15 October**.
- Work collaboratively with your registered team throughout the competition.
- Understand the challenge statement and ensure your solution addresses the problem effectively.
- Keep track of checkpoints, jury evaluations, announcements, and submission deadlines.
- Ensure your final solution is submitted within the stipulated time. Late submissions may not be considered.
- Be prepared to explain your solution, demonstrate your prototype, and justify your approach during jury evaluations.

4. Activities & Participant Experiences

Participants can explore the following activities during designated slots:

- **PET (Placement Employability Test):** Assess your employability skills.
- **AI Mock Interview:** Practise interviews and receive feedback.

- **Career Passport:** Explore your career-readiness journey.
- **Career Guidance:** Gain insights into career opportunities and industry expectations.
- **Call a Friend:** Participate in the designated engagement activity.

These activities will operate around the hackathon schedule and critical evaluation checkpoints. Please follow on-ground announcements for timings and availability.

5. What Defines a Winning Team?

At Founder's Code, the winning team is decided based on the combined Tech and Business performance. A team cannot compete with only a Tech component; every team must have representation from both tracks.

If your team is currently registered under the Tech Track only, you must do ONE of the following before competing:

1. Restructure your existing team: Assign one of your current team members to represent the Business/Sales Track.
2. Add one additional member: Include an extra team member to represent the Business/Sales Track.

The Business/Sales representative must contribute to the business strategy, market research, feasibility, and commercial potential of the solution.

Important: Both Tech and Business contributions are essential. The winner will be the team that brings both together to build a solution that is technically strong and business-ready.

6. Code of Conduct

- Maintain professional behaviour and respect fellow participants, mentors, jury members, and organisers.
- Follow the instructions provided by the organising team and college coordinators.
- Use the venue, equipment, and facilities responsibly.
- Do not engage in plagiarism, misrepresentation, or unauthorised use of another team's work.
- Keep your workspace clean and respect the venue's rules.
- Report any technical issues or concerns to the organising team promptly.

7. Important Reminders

- Stay updated with official communications and on-ground announcements.
- Keep your laptop charged and carry your charger.
- Plan your work around the scheduled checkpoints and final submission.
- Coordinate with your teammates and manage your time effectively.
- Follow the organisers' instructions regarding food, breaks, Wi-Fi access, and other event facilities.

We look forward to seeing you at **Founder's Code 2026!**

Topic domains

1. Rural Healthcare
2. Skill Gap and Youth Employability
3. Cyber security
4. Environmental Sustainability

Explanation of the domains

1. Rural Healthcare

Improve access to essential healthcare information and services for rural and underserved communities.

Examples: health-service navigation, maternal health follow-up reminders, multilingual preventive-care information, community health-worker support.

Things to Keep in Mind: No unsupported diagnosis, treatment advice or autonomous medical decisions.

2. Skill Gap & Youth Employability

Address the mismatch between young people's skills and real employment opportunities.

Examples: skills-gap mapping, personalized learning pathways, interview readiness, local job discovery, inclusive vocational training.

Things to Keep in Mind: Avoid discriminatory hiring recommendations; explain matching criteria.

3. Cybersecurity & Digital Safety

Protect individuals, businesses and communities from cyber threats, online fraud and digital security risks.

Examples: phishing and scam detection, cyber-awareness training, digital identity protection, fraud-reporting assistance, password-security assessment, cybersecurity readiness for small businesses, AI-powered threat monitoring.

Things to Keep in Mind: Ensure data privacy, responsible handling of sensitive information and ethical security practices. Solutions must not enable unauthorized access, surveillance or offensive cyberattacks.

4. Environment & Sustainability

Enable communities and organizations to reduce waste, conserve resources and improve environmental outcomes.

Examples: waste segregation guidance, water-leak reporting, energy-use optimization, pollution hotspot mapping, circular-economy solutions.

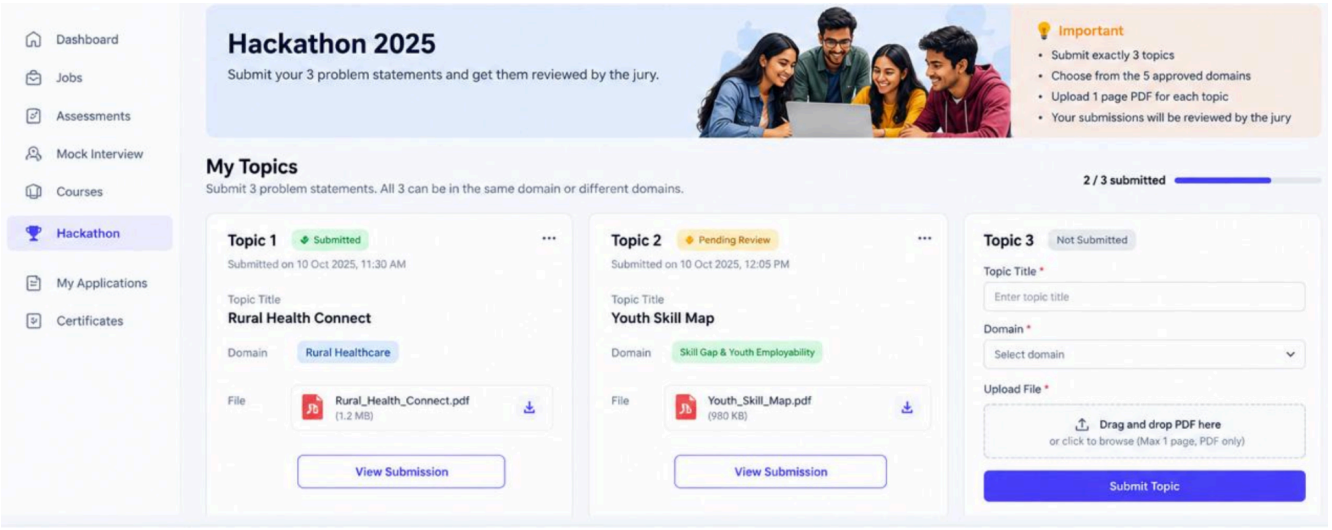
Things to Keep in Mind: Use credible environmental assumptions and define measurable outcomes.

Hackathon – Problem Statement Submission Format

Each team must submit 3 proposed problem statements from the 5 approved domains. All 3 can belong to the same domain, different domains, or any combination.

Each problem statement must be submitted as a separate 1-page proposal, covering both the technical solution and business viability.

Submission will be done on Prosculpt.ai portal.
Example:



Format of the PDF to upload in the Prosculpt.ai portal

1-Page Proposal Template – Headers

1. Topic Title
2. Domain Selection
3. Problem Statement – What problem are you solving?
4. Proposed Solution – What is your idea?
5. Technical Approach – How will you build it?
   - Technology Stack
   - Key Features
   - Prototype / MVP Feasibility
6. Business Approach – How will it succeed?
   - Target Customers / Users
   - Revenue Model
   - Go-to-Market (GTM) Strategy
7. Expected Impact – What difference will it make?
8. Challenges & Risks – What are the potential challenges and how will you address them?